

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior IT Cyber Security Specialist | Security Engineering | Incident Response | Threat Monitoring | Vulnerability Management

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer and Specialist with over five years of hands-on experience delivering enterprise-grade security engineering, incident response, threat monitoring, and vulnerability management across complex, large-scale environments. I bring deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, combined with proficiency in Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Single Sign-On (SSO), Conditional Access, and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA). My career has been built on taking ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture, working closely with infrastructure and operations teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents, and continually strengthen organisational security posture. I am comfortable operating as a subject-matter expert in a professional services environment, translating complex security requirements into practical, proportionate controls aligned with frameworks including NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and the MITRE ATT&CK framework.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL (Kusto Query Language) detection engineering, CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Gen SIEM (NG-SIEM), alert triage, threat hunting
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Single Sign-On (SSO), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) and Certificate Management:** SSL/TLS certificate lifecycle management, enterprise PKI architecture understanding
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); remediation tracking and penetration test finding management
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle (preparation, detection, containment, eradication, recovery), digital forensics, threat intelligence integration
- **Security Architecture and Engineering:** Microsoft Defender suite deployment and configuration, SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation and Response) automation, security policy design
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast email security, web content filtering
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Microsoft Intune, endpoint policy enforcement
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR playbook development
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Infrastructure Security:** Windows Server, firewall administration (Check Point Harmony), network security monitoring, Tanium endpoint management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 – Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Lead hands-on security engineering and threat monitoring operations across a complex enterprise environment covering 8,000+ users, taking ownership of cybersecurity controls from detection through to remediation.

- Architect and maintain Microsoft Sentinel as the primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, developing advanced KQL detection rules, correlation analytics, and automated alerting to identify threats across the enterprise estate.
- Deploy, configure, and optimise Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the full user estate, ensuring comprehensive Extended Detection and Response (XDR) coverage and integration with Microsoft 365 Defender.
- Lead incident response activities end-to-end following the NIST SP 800-61 framework, coordinating investigation, containment, eradication, and recovery, and documenting lessons learned to strengthen future posture.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques, and procedures, identifying latent threats and adversary activity before escalation.
- Administer the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); prioritise and track remediation in collaboration with infrastructure operations teams.
- Manage Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, Single Sign-On (SSO), and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) to enforce Zero Trust identity principles across the estate.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution to control and audit privileged account usage across critical systems.
- Develop PowerShell automation scripts and SOAR playbooks to streamline repetitive security operations, reduce mean time to respond, and ensure consistent process execution.
- Oversee Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policy enforcement, ensuring compliant endpoint posture across managed devices.
- Manage Mimecast email security gateway to detect and block phishing, spam, and malware campaigns targeting the user estate.
- Operate CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Gen SIEM (NG-SIEM) for advanced threat detection, log management, and security analytics alongside Microsoft Sentinel.
- Administer Check Point Harmony firewall policies and network security controls, and support Tanium-based endpoint visibility and management.
- Contribute to security architecture reviews, risk assessments, and policy development aligned with ISO 27001, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, and Cyber Essentials+ frameworks.

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2022 – March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Delivered daily security operations covering alert triage, incident management, vulnerability scanning, and threat hunting across a multi-site enterprise environment.
- Administered and tuned CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Prevent modules to detect and block endpoint threats, reducing false positives through policy refinement.
- Supported the build-out of Microsoft Sentinel as the enterprise SIEM, developing KQL queries and detection analytics to surface high-fidelity alerts from Microsoft Defender and other log sources.
- Managed identity security through Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), enforcing Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO policies, and investigating identity-based threats using Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI).
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and Tenable.io, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports for infrastructure and operations teams.
- Performed digital forensic triage and supported incident response investigations, producing post-incident reports and actionable recommendations.
- Administered Mimecast email filtering policies and investigated email-borne threats including phishing and business email compromise attempts.
- Contributed to security awareness training initiatives and maintained security documentation, policies, and procedure guides.
- Supported Cyber Essentials+ accreditation programme by evidencing compliance controls and remediating identified gaps.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 – March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Implemented and maintained security controls across a cloud-hosted SaaS platform, managing endpoint security, access controls, and infrastructure hardening in a fast-paced FinTech environment.
- Supported IT security governance, including security policy design, risk assessments, and supplier security reviews aligned with ISO 27001 principles.
- Managed identity and access management processes, provisioning and de-provisioning user accounts and enforcing least-privilege access principles.
- Delivered incident management support, investigating security events and coordinating remediation with engineering and development teams.
- Contributed to IT quality assurance processes, infrastructure monitoring, and system reliability activities across the SaaS platform estate.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, delivering comprehensive Extended Detection and Response (XDR) visibility and significantly reducing dwell time for active threats.
- Built and tuned a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM) detection library using KQL analytics, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) threats by correlating signals from Defender, Entra ID, and endpoint telemetry.
- Engineered SOAR automation playbooks in PowerShell to orchestrate incident response workflows, eliminating manual steps and accelerating containment of endpoint and identity-based incidents.
- Led the Cyber Essentials+ certification programme, coordinating evidence gathering across infrastructure and security teams and achieving accreditation within the target timeline.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce just-in-time and just-enough access for privileged accounts, reducing the attack surface from standing administrative privileges.
- Established a structured vulnerability management programme integrating Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), enabling risk-prioritised remediation and measurable reduction in the organisation's exploitable attack surface.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)